

5.1 Browsers

Internet Explorer is Windows' default browser, and thanks to the omnipresence of that OS, it is the most popular. Next in popularity comes Firefox, a product from the team responsible for the wildly popular Netscape Communicator browser. Opera comes in third.

5.1.1 Opera 9 (www.opera.com)

We have covered Opera 9 in chapter 6, the chapter on Essentials.

5.1.2 Firefox 2 (www.mozilla.com/en-US/firefox/)

Firefox 2 improves upon previous versions by adding security features like the inclusion of an Identity Theft detection mechanism which alerts users when they visit a link that is questionable, besides adding support for RSS feeds, a spell checker, and the provision to restore a browsing session.

Thanks to its open source nature, a strong developer community is constantly making improvements to the browser while fanatically promoting it. This community is also responsible for the wide choice of add-ons for Firefox, which greatly enhance its core capabilities, making it the most versatile of browsers. While the base download offers a vanilla browser with tabbed browsing and a download manager, it is the add-ons that give Firefox the punch.

Add-ons

Add-ons can be installed by going to **Tools > Add-ons**. The add-ons window that comes up lets one install add-ons and manage those already installed. One can also visit <https://addons.mozilla.org/firefox/extensions/>. Clicking on the “download” link for the add-on downloads and installs the add-on, but for it to come into effect, the browser needs to



Managing add-ons in Firefox